AGI Strategy Reading List

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Abstract

Collection of readings for the October 2026 AGI Strategy Intensive. Links do not include details such as when reading instructions recommened only a few pages for a specific section. Readings are structure around unit and section.

Unit 1: The Race to AGI

What's at Stake

Required Readings

- Selsam, Daniel. 2026. "Daniel Selsam - Personal Statement on AI Risk." Google Docs. September 14. https://docs.google.com/document/d/1NRSfwBrVGWkBE24zRKOeP_Ksmx8ZRLbIwsF1k8pjDfA/edit?

Optional Readings

- Karnofsky, Holden. 2021. "The Most Important Century (in a Nutshell)." Cold Takes. September 23. https://www.cold-takes.com/the-most-important-century-in-a-nutshell/.
- Amodei, Dario. 2024. "Machines of Loving Grace." October. https://darioamodei.com/essay/machines-of-loving-grace.
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What Future do you want?

Optional Readings

- Carlsmith, Joe. 2022. "Actually Possible: Thoughts on Utopia." Joe Carlsmith. October 12. https://joecarlsmith.com/2021/01/18/actually-possible-thoughts-on-utopia.
- Binder, Damon. 2026. "Post-AGI, We Are All Jobless Aristocrats." Defenses in Depth. September 11. https://defensesindepth.bio/post-agi-we-are-all-jobless-aristocrats/.
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Competition and Coordination

Required Readings

- Karnofsky, Holden. 2022. "Racing Through a Minefield: The AI Deployment Problem." Cold Takes. December 22. https://www.cold-takes.com/racing-through-a-minefield-the-ai-deployment-problem/.
- Wildeford, Peter. 2026. "The Scramble: Getting in Position to Pace the Frontier." August 20. https://blog.peterwildeford.com/p/the-scramble-getting-in-position.

Recommended Readings

- Toner, Helen. 2025. "In Search of a Dynamist Vision for Safe Superhuman AI." Substack newsletter. Rising Tide. May 12. https://helentoner.substack.com/p/dynamism-vs-stasis.
- Samuel, Sigal. 2024. "It's Practically Impossible to Run a Big AI Company Ethically." Vox. August 2. https://www.vox.com/future-perfect/364384/its-practically-impossible-to-run-a-big-ai-company-ethically.
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- "The Intelligence Age." 2024. September 23. https://ia.samaltman.com/?utm_source=bluedot-impact.
- Ó hÉigeartaigh, Seán. 2025. "The Most Dangerous Fiction: The Rhetoric and Reality of the AI Race." SSRN Scholarly Paper. Rochester, NY. May 25. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5278644.

Responding to the Hugging Face Incident

Required Readings

- Patel, Dwarkesh. 2026. "The Rise and Fall of Agent Civilizations." August 29. https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/openai-huggingface.

Optional Readings

- Patel, Dwarkesh. 2026. "Ajeya Cotra – Inside the OpenAI Agent Swarm That Hacked Hugging Face." September 1. https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/ajeya-cotra.
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- Woo, Erin, and Robert McMillan. 2026. "Gemini Hacked Three Companies in First Known Breakout by Google's AI." *Wall Street Journal: Tech*, September 18. https://www.wsj.com/tech/ai/gemini-hacked-three-companies-in-first-known-breakout-by-googles-ai-5c0baba2.
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- "Pacing the Frontier." 2026. July. https://www.pacingthefrontier.com/.

Unit 2: Drivers of AI Progress

What Drives AI Progress

Required Readings

- Todd, Benjamin. 2025. "The Case for AGI by 2030." 80,000 Hours. March. https://80000hours.org/ai/guide/when-will-agi-arrive/.
- Owen, David. 2025. "What Will AI Look Like in 2030?" Epoch AI. September 16. https://epoch.ai/publications/what-will-ai-look-like-in-2030.

Optional Readings

- Sevilla, Jaime, Tamay Besiroglu, Ben Cottier, Josh You, Edu Roldán, Pablo Villalobos, and Ege Erdil. 2026. "Can AI Scaling Continue Through 2030?" Epoch AI. Accessed October 16. https://epoch.ai/publications/can-ai-scaling-continue-through-2030.
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- Barak, ~ Boaz. 2026. "The State of AI Safety in Four Fake Graphs." Windows On Theory. March 30. https://windowsontheory.org/2026/03/30/the-state-of-ai-safety-in-four-fake-graphs/.
- Patel, Dwarkesh. 2026. "Dario Amodei — "We Are Near the End of the Exponential"." February 13. https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/dario-amodei-2.

What can increasingly capable AI systems do?

Required Readings

- "Trends in AI." 2026. Epoch AI. February 5. https://epoch.ai/trends.
- "Epoch Capabilities Index." 2026. Epoch AI. Accessed October 16. https://epoch.ai/eci.
- "Benchmarks - Epoch AI." 2026. Epoch AI. Accessed October 16. https://epoch.ai/benchmarks/search.
- "Frontier Risk Report (February to March 2026)." 2026. *METR Blog*, May. https://metr.org/blog/2026-05-19-frontier-risk-report/.
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- Starace, Giulio, Oliver Jaffe, Dane Sherburn, James Aung, Jun Shern Chan, Leon Maksin, Rachel Dias, et al. 2025. "PaperBench: Evaluating AI's Ability to Replicate AI Research." April 7. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2504.01848.
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- *What a 100-Year-Old Horse Teaches Us about AI*. 2025. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eP1dSWFqKVs.

How could progress accelerate from here?

Required Readings

- Kokotajlo, Daniel, Scott Alexander, and Thomas Larsen. 2025. "AI 2027." April 3. https://ai-2027.com/.

- Lifland, Eli. 2026. "Q2.5 2026 Timelines Update: Uplift and Revenue." August 16. https://blog.aifutures.org/p/q25-2026-timelines-update-uplift.
- Cunningham, Tom, Lukas Althoff, Basil Halperin, Brian Jabarian, Andrew Koh, Arjun Ramani, Phil Trammell, Parker Whitfill, and Cheryl Wu. 2026. "The Economics of Recursive Self-Improvement," July.

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- Holden Karnofsky. 2022. "AI Strategy Nearcasting." Effective Altruism Forum. August 26. https://forum.effectivealtruism.org/posts/ktEzS3pkfeqPNh6r5/ai-strategy-nearcasting.
- Grace, Katja, Harlan Stewart, Julia Fabienne Sandkühler, Stephen Thomas, Ben Weinstein-Raun, Jan Brauner, and Richard C. Korzekwa. 2025. "Thousands of AI Authors on the Future of AI." *Journal of Artificial Intelligence Research* 84 (October). doi:10.1613/jair.1.19087.
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- "Scenarios for Our Economic Future." 2026. September. https://www.anthropic.com/institute/econ-scenarios.
- Reed, Tom. 2026. "The Goodhart Singularity." Substack newsletter. Meagre Protestant History. May 7. https://meagreprotestanthistory.substack.com/p/the-goodhart-singularity.
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Unit 3: Pathways to Harm

Loss of Control

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- Karnofsky, Holden. 2022. "AI Could Defeat All Of Us Combined." Cold Takes. June 9. https://www.cold-takes.com/ai-could-defeat-all-of-us-combined/.
- Stix, Charlotte, Annika Hallensleben, Alejandro Ortega, and Matteo Pistillo. 2025. "The Loss of Control Playbook | Apollo Research." Apollo Research. December 9.

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- Grace, Katja. 2022. "Counterarguments to the Basic AI x-Risk Case." LessWrong. October 14. https://www.lesswrong.com/posts/LDRQ5Zfqwi8GjzPYG/counterarguments-to-the-basic-ai-x-risk-case.
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Authoritarianism

Required Reading

- Hadshar, Rose. 2025. "Extreme Power Concentration." 80,000 Hours. October. https://80000hours.org/problem-profiles/extreme-power-concentration/.

Recommended Reading

- Imas, Alex. 2026. "What Will Be Scarce?" Substack newsletter. Ghosts of Electricity. April 14. https://aleximas.substack.com/p/what-will-be-scarce.
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- *Could a Global Dictatorship Last Forever?* 2026. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Wv3p9WCs6M.

Biological Misuse

Required Readings

- Esvelt, Kevin. 2026. "On Civilization-Threatening Bioweapons." Tweet. Twitter. September 16. https://x.com/kesvelt/status/2100238200207716488.
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Optional Readings

- Bakerlee, Chris. 2021. "Mother Nature Bioterrorism.pdf." Google Docs. January 8. https://drive.google.com/file/d/1cs_3EJUd9vmZKmhs16pESMgfIunHbPur/view?utm_source=bluedot-impact&usp=embed_facebook.
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- Mouton, Christopher A., Caleb Lucas, and Ella Guest. 2024. "The Operational Risks of AI in Large-Scale Biological Attacks: Results of a Red-Team Study." https://www.rand.org/pubs/research_reports/RRA2977-2.html.

Unit 4: Strategies for the AGI Transition

Orienting to the Strategy

Required Reading

- Larsen, Thomas, Romeo Dean, Brendan Halstead, Eli Lifland, Ryan Greenblatt, and Daniel Kokotajlo. 2026. "AI 2040: Plan A." AI 2040. https://ai-2040.com/summary.

Recommended Readings

- "The Library." 2026. AI Alignment Forum. Accessed October 16. https://www.alignmentforum.org/.

The Technical Challenge

Required Readings

- Shah, Rohin, Alex Irpan, Alexander Matt Turner, Anna Wang, Arthur Conmy, David Lindner, Jonah Brown-Cohen, et al. 2025. "An Approach to Technical AGI Safety and Security." Google DeepMind.
- Hubinger, Evan. 2025. "Alignment Remains a Hard, Unsolved Problem." LessWrong. November 27. https://www.lesswrong.com/posts/epjuxGnSPof3GnMSL/alignment-remains-a-hard-unsolved-problem.
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Following the Transition